Sauerkraut is an excellent source of vitamin C. This hearty soup is redolent of Eastern Europe, although Chinese cooks were pickling cabbage in wine as early as 200 BCE.

sauerkraut soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

2 tbsp vegetable oil
1 onion, finely chopped
3½oz (100g) bacon, diced
1 x 14oz (400g) jar or can sauerkraut, coarsely chopped
1 x 14oz (400g) can chopped tomatoes, peeled
2 tsp sugar
2½ cups hot vegetable or chicken stock
¾ cup heavy cream
freshly ground black pepper

1 Heat the vegetable oil in a large saucepan over low heat. Add the chopped onion and cook gently until softened but not browned. Then add the diced bacon and cook for another 3 minutes. Finally add the chopped sauerkraut, cover, and continue to cook for another 5 minutes, stirring from time to time.

2 Increase the heat under the saucepan slightly and add the chopped tomatoes, sugar, hot stock, heavy cream, and freshly ground black pepper and stir well. Bring to a simmer over medium heat for 15 minutes until the sauerkraut is tender. Ladle the soup into bowls to serve and eat with toasted rye bread.